

File Handling

File handling in python is a way to work with files using python programs. It helps us to create files, read data from files, write data into files, update files, and delete files using a python program.

Normally, when a program runs, data is stored in memory (RAM). Once the program stops, the data is lost. File handling allows us to store data permanently in files so that it can be accessed later.

Why Do We Need File Handling?

Without file handling:

- Data exists only while the program is running.
- Data is lost when the program closes.

With file handling:

- Data is permanently stored.
- Data can be shared between applications.
- Large amounts of information can be managed efficiently.

Example:

```
file = open("student.txt", "w")
file.write("priya")
file.close()
```

output: Priya

File:

A file is a collection of related information stored on a storage device such as a hard disk, SSD, or USB drive. Files are used to save data permanently so that it can be accessed and modified whenever required.

Examples of files include text documents, images, videos, PDFs, spreadsheets, and log files.

Examples:

- student.txt
- employees.csv
- report.pdf
- image.jpg

Example:

```
file = open("employee.txt", "w")
file.write("employee data")
file.close()
```

output: A file named employee.txt is created.

Creating a File:

Creating a file in Python means generating a new file on the computer using a Python program. Files are created to store information permanently so that it can be used later.

Python provides different modes such as w and x to create files.

Example:

```
file = open("student.txt", "w")
file.close()
```

output: After execution, a new file named student.txt is created.

Text File:

A text file is a type of file that stores data in a human-readable format. The contents of a text file can be viewed and edited using text editors such as Notepad, VS Code, or Sublime Text.

Text files store information as characters and are commonly used for storing notes, reports, configuration data, and application logs.

Examples

- .txt files
- .csv files
- .json files
- .xml files

```
file = open("notes.txt", "w")
file.write("python notes")
file.close()
```

output:python notes

Binary File:

A binary file is a file that stores data in binary format (0s and 1s) instead of readable text. Binary files are generally used to store images, videos, audio files, and documents.

Unlike text files, binary files cannot be easily understood by humans because their contents are stored in machine-readable format.

Examples

- image.jpg
- video.mp4
- music.mp3
- document.pdf

```
file = open("image.bin", "wb")
file.write(b"hello")
file.close()
```

Reading Binary File:

```
file = open("image.bin", "rb")
print(file.read())
file.close()
```

output:b"hello"

open() Function:

The open() function is used to open an existing file or create a new file for performing operations such as reading, writing, or appending data.

Before performing any operation on a file, Python must establish a connection between the program and the file. This connection is created using the `open()` function.

Syntax:

`file = open("filename", "mode")`

Parameters:

`filename` → Name of the file to be opened.

`mode` → Specifies the operation to be performed on the file.

Example:

```
file = open("student.txt", "r")
print("file opened successfully")
file.close()
```

output:file opened successfully

In this example:

- student.txt is the file name.
- r represents read mode.

File Modes:

File modes specify how a file should be opened and what operations are allowed on that file. Different modes are available for reading, writing, appending, and creating files.

Common File Modes:

Mode	Meaning
"r"	Read file
"w"	Write file
"a"	Append data
"x"	Create new file
"r+"	Read and write
"rb"	Binary file for reading
"rw"	Binary file for write
"a+"	Appending and reading

Read Mode (r):

Read mode is used to open a file for reading its contents. In this mode, data can only be viewed and cannot be modified.

The file must already exist; otherwise, Python raises a `FileNotFoundError`.

Use Cases

- Reading reports
- Reading configuration files
- Viewing stored records

Example: used to read existing files

```
file = open("student.txt", "r")
print(file.read())
file.close()
```

output: Python
Django
Flask

Write Mode (w):

Write mode is used to write data into a file. If the file already exists, all existing content is removed and replaced with new content. If the file does not exist, Python creates a new file automatically.

Use Cases

- Creating reports
- Saving user information
- Exporting data

Example:

```
file = open("student.txt", "w")  
file.write("Django")  
file.close()
```

output: Django

Append Mode (a):

Append mode is used to add new data at the end of an existing file without removing the previous content.

This mode is useful when historical records need to be maintained.

Use Cases

- Attendance systems
- Transaction records
- Application logs

Example:

```
file = open("student.txt", "a")  
file.write("\nFastAPI")  
file.close()
```

output:FastAPI

Reading a File:

Reading a file means retrieving the information stored inside it. Python provides different methods to read data from files depending on the requirement.

Benefits

- Access stored data
- Generate reports
- Analyze information

Example:

```
file = open("student.txt", "r")  
data = file.read()  
print(data)  
file.close()
```

output:Django

Writing to a File:

Writing to a file means storing new information inside a file. This operation is commonly used to save user data, create reports, and generate output files.

- Benefits
- Permanent storage
- Easy data management
- Information backup

Example:

```
file = open("marks.txt", "w")
file.write("total marks:95")
file.close()
```

output: total marks:95

File Pointer:

A file pointer is an internal cursor that keeps track of the current position within a file. Whenever data is read or written, the file pointer automatically moves forward.

The file pointer helps Python know where the next read or write operation should take place.

Example:

```
file = open("student.txt", "r")
print(file.read(3))
print(file.tell())
file.close()
```

output:pyt

3

seek() Method:

The seek() method is used to move the file pointer to a specific location within the file.

It allows random access to data rather than reading the file from the beginning every time.

Benefits

- Faster access to data
- Random file navigation
- Efficient processing of large files

Example:

```
file = open("student.txt", "r")
file.seek(2)
print(file.read())
file.close()
```

if file contains : python

output: thon

tell() Method:

The tell() method returns the current position of the file pointer within the file.

It is useful when tracking the location from which data is being read or written.

Benefits

- Position tracking
- Debugging file operations
- Better file management

Example:

```
file = open("student.txt", "r")
print(file.tell())
file.read(4)
print(file.tell())
file.close()
```

output: 0

4

close() Method:

The close() method is used to close an opened file after all operations have been completed.

Closing a file releases system resources and ensures that all data is saved properly.

Importance

- Prevents memory leaks
- Improves performance
- Protects data integrity

with Statement:

The with statement is the recommended way of working with files in Python. It automatically closes the file after operations are completed, even if an error occurs during execution.

Benefits

- Automatic file closing
- Cleaner code
- Better exception handling
- Improved resource management

Example:

```
with open("student.txt", "r") as file:
    print(file.read())
```

output: Python

Django

File is automatically closed

readline() Method:

The readline() method is used to read **one line at a time** from a file. Unlike read(), which reads the entire file, readline() reads only a single line and moves the file pointer to the next line.

Why Do We Use readline()?

- To read files line by line
- To process large files efficiently
- To save memory
- To access specific lines

Example File:

Assume student.txt contains:

```
Priya
Rahul
Anjali
kiran
```

Reading First Line:

```
file = open("student.txt", "r")
print(file.readline())
file.close()
```

output: Priya

Reading Multiple Lines:

```
file = open("student.txt", "r")
print(file.readline())
print(file.readline())
print(file.readline())
file.close()
```

Output: Priya

Rahul

Anjali

Deleting a File in Python:

Deleting a file in Python means removing a file permanently from your computer using a Python program. After a file is deleted, it cannot be used for reading, writing, or updating.

Python provides the `os.remove()` function to delete files.

Why Do We Need to Delete Files?

Sometimes files are no longer needed and occupy unnecessary storage space. Deleting such files helps keep the system organized and improves storage management.

For example:

- Removing old reports
- Deleting temporary files
- Removing outdated records
- Cleaning log files

How Python Deletes a File

To delete a file, Python uses the `os` module.

Step 1: Import the os Module

```
import os
```

Step 2: Delete the File

```
os.remove("student.txt")
```

This statement deletes the file named student.txt.

Example:

```
import os
os.remove("student.txt")
```

The file will be removed from your system.

Checking Before Deleting

If the file does not exist, Python will show an error.

To avoid this, first check whether the file exists.

```
import os
if os.path.exists("student.txt"):
    os.remove("student.txt")
    print("File deleted successfully")
else:
    print("File not found")
```

output: File deleted successfully
or File not found

Advantages of Deleting Files

- Frees storage space
- Removes unwanted files
- Keeps folders organized
- Improves file management

Important Points

- Deleted files are removed permanently.
- Always check if the file exists before deleting.
- Use exception handling for safer programs.
- Be careful while deleting important files.

Exception Handling in File Operations:

Exception handling is used to manage errors that may occur while working with files. It prevents the program from crashing and allows developers to handle errors gracefully.

Example:

```
try:
    file = open("data.txt", "r")
    print(file.read())
except FileNotFoundError:
    print("File not found")
```

output: File not found

Benefits

- Improved reliability
- Better user experience
- Safer file operations

Generator and Yield in Python

Introduction:

A **Generator** is a special type of function in Python that allows us to generate values one at a time instead of generating all values at once.

- Generators are useful when working with large amounts of data because they save memory and improve performance.
- A generator uses the **yield** keyword instead of the **return** keyword.

What is a Generator?

Definition: A Generator is a function that returns an iterator and produces values one by one using the yield keyword.

Unlike normal functions, generators do not store all values in memory at once. They generate values only when needed.

Syntax:

```
def generator_name():  
    yield value
```

Example:

```
def numbers():  
    yield 1  
    yield 2  
    yield 3  
g = numbers()  
print(next(g))  
print(next(g))  
print(next(g))
```

Output:1

2

3

Why Do We Need Generators?

Without Generator:

```
numbers = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]
```

All values are stored in memory.

With Generator:

```
def numbers():  
    yield 1  
    yield 2  
    yield 3
```

Values are generated only when required.

Benefits

- Memory efficient
- Faster execution
- Suitable for large datasets
- Supports lazy evaluation

What is yield?

Definition : The yield keyword is used to return a value from a generator function without terminating the function.

When yield is encountered:

1. The current value is returned.
2. The function pauses its execution.
3. The function remembers its current state.
4. Execution resumes from the same position when called again.

Syntax

yield value

Difference Between return and yield

return	yield
Terminates function	Pauses function
Returns single value	Returns multiple values one by one
Function ends	Function resumes later
Uses more memory	Uses less memory

Example: Using return

```
def demo():  
    return 10  
    return 20  
print(demo())
```

Output:10

Example: Using yield

```
def demo():  
    yield 10  
    yield 20  
g = demo()  
print(next(g))  
print(next(g))
```

Output:10

20

How Generator Works

Example:

```
def numbers():  
    yield 10  
    yield 20  
    yield 30  
g=numbers()  
print(next(g))  
print(next(g))  
print(next(g))
```

Output:10

20

30

Execution Flow

Step 1:

`next(g)`

Returns:

10

Function pauses at first yield.

Step 2:

`next(g)`

Returns:

20

Execution resumes after first yield.

Step 3:

`next(g)`

Returns:

30

Execution resumes after second yield.

Generator Example Using Loop:

```
def fruits():  
    yield "Apple"  
    yield "Mango"  
    yield "Orange"  
for item in fruits():  
    print(item)
```

Output:Apple

Mango

Orange

Generator for Range of Numbers:

```
def count():  
    for i in range(1, 6):  
        yield i  
for num in count():  
    print(num)
```

Output:1

2

3

4

5

Generator Object:

When a generator function is called, it does not execute immediately.

Instead, it returns a generator object.

Example:

```
def demo():  
    yield 1  
g = demo()  
print(g)
```

Output:<generator object demo at 0x000001>

next() Function: The next() function is used to retrieve the next value from a generator.

Syntax

next(generator_object)

Example:

```
def numbers():  
    yield 10  
    yield 20  
g=numbers()  
print(next(g))  
print(next(g))
```

Output:10

20

StopIteration Exception: When all values are exhausted, Python raises a StopIteration exception.

Example:

```
def numbers():  
    yield 1  
g=numbers()  
print(next(g))  
print(next(g))
```

Output:1

StopIteration

Generator Expression: A generator expression is a shorter way to create generators.

It is similar to list comprehension but uses parentheses.

Syntax:

(expression for item in iterable)

Example:

```
numbers = (x*x for x in range(1, 6))  
for num in numbers:  
    print(num)
```

Output:

1

4

9

16

25

Generator vs List

List Example:

numbers = [x*x for x in range(1, 1000000)]

Stores all values in memory.

Generator Example

```
numbers = (x*x for x in range(1, 1000000))
```

Generates values one by one.

Difference Between List and Generator

List	Generator
Uses []	Uses ()
Stores all values	Generates values one by one
More memory	Less memory
Faster access	Slower access
Suitable for small data	Suitable for large data

Real-Time Example 1: Reading Large Files

Without Generator:

```
file = open("data.txt")
data = file.readlines()
```

Loads entire file into memory.

Using Generator:

```
def read_file():
    with open("data.txt") as file:
        for line in file:
            yield line
```

Reads one line at a time

Real-Time Example 2: Even Numbers Generator

```
def even_numbers(n):
    for i in range(n):
        if i % 2 == 0:
            yield i
for num in even_numbers(10):
    print(num)
```

Output:

```
0
2
4
6
8
```

Real-Time Example 3: Infinite Sequence

```
def infinite():
    num = 1
    while True:
        yield num
        num += 1
g = infinite()
print(next(g))
print(next(g))
print(next(g))
```

Output:

1
2
3

Advantages of Generators:

- Memory efficient
- Faster execution for large datasets
- Lazy evaluation
- Produces values on demand
- Useful for streams and large files
- Reduces memory consumption

Disadvantages of Generators:

- Cannot access values using indexes
- Values can be used only once
- Slightly slower for small datasets
- Harder to debug compared to lists